

LATAA Football Academy

COACHES' CODE OF CONDUCT

1. OUR COMMITMENT

At LATAA Football Academy, we are committed to providing a safe, positive, inclusive and professional environment where every young player can enjoy football and reach their potential.

All coaches are expected to act as positive role models and uphold the highest standards of professional behaviour at all times.

The welfare, safety and development of our players must always be our priority.

2. LATAA COACH'S, AGREE TO:

Professional Standards

- Put the welfare, safety and development of every player first.
 - Treat every player with dignity, respect and fairness.
 - Create a positive, encouraging and inclusive learning environment.
 - Be professional, reliable, punctual and appropriately prepared for every session.
 - Deliver age-appropriate, engaging and challenging coaching sessions.
 - Continue to develop my coaching knowledge and skills.
 - Follow LATAA Football Academy policies and procedures.
 - Represent LATAA positively at all times.
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3. SAFEGUARDING

- Follow the LATAA Safeguarding Children Policy.
- Report any safeguarding concern immediately to the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).
- Take every concern raised by a child seriously.
- Listen to children and allow them to speak without judgement.
- Never promise to keep a safeguarding disclosure secret.
- Never investigate a safeguarding concern myself.
- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries with all players.
- Never engage in behaviour that could place a child at risk of harm.
- Ensure that any physical contact with players is appropriate, necessary and proportionate.

- Never use humiliating, threatening, abusive or discriminatory language.
 - Never engage in sexualised behaviour or communication with a child.
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4. PROFESSIONAL RELATIONSHIPS AND BOUNDARIES

Coaches must maintain appropriate professional boundaries with players.

- Keep all relationships with players professional.
 - Avoid unnecessary one-to-one situations with children where possible.
 - Avoid private or inappropriate communication with players.
 - Use official LATAA communication channels wherever possible.
 - Include parents or carers in communications where appropriate.
 - Never meet a player privately outside LATAA activities without appropriate safeguarding arrangements and parental consent.
 - Never give inappropriate gifts, money or personal favours to players.
 - Never engage in inappropriate physical contact.
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5. COACHING ENVIRONMENT

- Encourage players to enjoy football and develop a lifelong love of the game.
 - Recognise that every player develops at a different rate.
 - Provide constructive feedback and encouragement.
 - Never ridicule, embarrass or humiliate a player.
 - Never use fear, intimidation or excessive criticism as a coaching method.
 - Promote teamwork, respect, discipline and good sportsmanship.
 - Encourage players to learn from mistakes.
 - Treat all players fairly and avoid favouritism.
 - Support players' individual needs and development.
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6. EQUALITY, DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION

- Treat every player equally and fairly.
 - Respect differences in race, nationality, religion, belief, disability, sex, gender, sexual orientation, age and background.
 - Never tolerate bullying, discrimination, harassment or abusive behaviour.
 - Challenge inappropriate behaviour appropriately.
 - Report any concerns about bullying or discrimination to the DSL or LATAA management.
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7. COMMUNICATION AND SOCIAL MEDIA

- Communicate with players in a professional and appropriate manner.
- Use LATAA-approved communication channels wherever possible.

- Maintain appropriate boundaries on social media.
 - Never send inappropriate messages, images or content to players.
 - Never request or encourage players to communicate secretly.
 - Never post inappropriate photographs or videos of players.
 - Follow LATAA's Photography, Filming and Social Media Policy.
 - Obtain appropriate consent before taking or sharing photographs or videos.
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8. PHOTOGRAPHY AND VIDEO

- Only photograph or record players where appropriate consent has been obtained.
 - Use images and videos only for legitimate LATAA purposes.
 - Never take inappropriate or compromising images of children.
 - Never share images of players through personal social media without authorisation.
 - Follow LATAA's policies regarding photography and video.
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9. HEALTH, SAFETY AND WELFARE

- Take reasonable steps to ensure the training environment is safe.
 - Follow venue health and safety procedures.
 - Ensure emergency procedures are followed.
 - Never knowingly allow an injured or unwell player to continue if it is unsafe.
 - Ensure players are appropriately supervised.
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10. ALCOHOL, DRUGS AND SMOKING

Will never:

- Coach while under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs.
 - Attend training or matches impaired by alcohol, drugs or any substance that could affect my ability to coach safely.
 - Use illegal drugs while working for or representing LATAA.
 - Smoke or vape in areas where children are present or where prohibited by the venue.
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11. CONFIDENTIALITY

- Respect the privacy of players and families.
- Keep personal and safeguarding information confidential.
- Only share information when there is a legitimate reason to do so.
- Follow LATAA's data protection and safeguarding procedures.

- Understand that confidentiality does not prevent information being shared where necessary to protect a child from harm.
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12. DBS AND SAFER RECRUITMENT

- May be required to complete an appropriate DBS check before working with children.
 - A DBS check does not replace LATAA's wider safer recruitment procedures.
 - Must inform LATAA if there is any relevant change in my circumstances that may affect my suitability to work with children.
 - Must complete any safeguarding training required by LATAA.
 - Must comply with LATAA's safeguarding requirements at all times.
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13. PARENTS AND CARERS

- Treat parents and carers respectfully.
 - Communicate professionally.
 - Avoid confrontational or inappropriate behaviour.
 - Refer serious complaints or concerns to LATAA management.
 - Never discuss confidential information about another player with a parent or carer.
 - Encourage parents and carers to support their child's development positively.
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14. REPORTING CONCERNS

Understand that safeguarding is everyone's responsibility.

If I have a concern about the welfare of a child, I will report it immediately to:

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL):

Name: Micah Hyde

Telephone: 07860136028

Email: micahhyde@mac.com

If a child is in immediate danger, I will contact the emergency services by calling **999**.

I understand that I must not investigate a safeguarding concern myself or promise a child that information will remain secret.

15. BREACHES OF THE CODE

Failure to follow this Code of Conduct may result in action being taken by LATAA Football Academy.

Depending on the seriousness of the behaviour, this may include:

- Informal advice or additional training.
- Formal warning.
- Suspension from coaching duties.
- Removal from coaching activities.
- Termination of employment or coaching agreement.
- Referral to the relevant football governing body.
- Referral to the Police or other statutory agencies where appropriate.

Any allegation involving the safety or welfare of a child will be managed in accordance with LATAA's Safeguarding Policy and relevant safeguarding procedures.

Date Adopted: 3 August 2026

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